General Assembly

STUDY GUIDE

# RESPONSIVE LAYOUTS

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## Overview

A **responsive layout** ensures that a webpage displays well on screens of any size, from large computer monitors to mobile phones.

### Width

- An element's width can be set as an exact number of pixels, or a percentage of the screen size.
- When width is a percentage of the screen size, the element's size will change according to the size of a browser window.
- To prevent elements from becoming too large (and possibly displaying poorly), you can set the `max-width` property followed by an exact number of pixels.

### Margin

- The margin property ensures your elements are well-placed, even as the page size changes.
- Create a set margin size by using the `margin` property followed by a number of pixels.
- Or, create a margin that changes with your page size:
    - `margin: 0` gives an element equal whitespace a the top and bottom
    - `margin: auto` gives an element equal whitespace to the left and right
    - `margin: 0 auto` does both

### Media Queries

- A **media query**, written as `@media`, allows you to apply styles based on certain properties.
- You can ask a browser to apply a rule only for screens above or below a certain number of pixels.
- Example: `@media screen and (max-width: 350 px)` tells browsers to only apply a given rule when a screen is under 350px wide.
- Media queries should go after the main rule for your element.

### Considerations

- If your page is more likely to be read on a small screen, use that to inform your initial design, rather than trying to account for it later.
- Your browser's developer tools or other web plugins will help you simulate smaller screens.
- Your HTML will stay the same across screen sizes; your CSS will account for adjustments.
- Remember: the more specific a rule, the lower down on your CSS style sheet it should go.